

Mumbai Calling

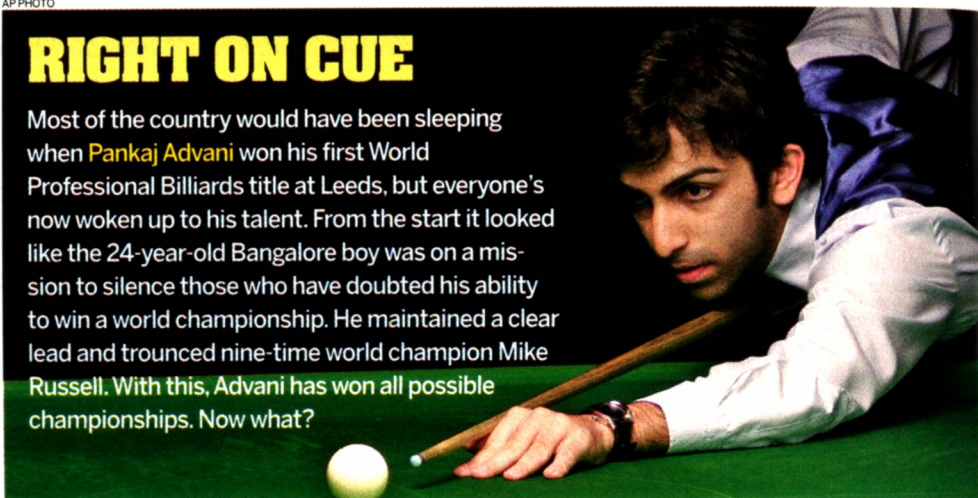
Biomedicine can wait. Reena Patel is saying hello to Bollywood. The 23-year-old biomedical graduate was recently crowned the first Miss Bollywood UK. As part of the prize, she gets to star in a film. The Shah Rukh Khan fan can't wait to come to Mumbai and spend at least one year here. "Three directors have shown interest in casting me. I'll most likely act in a crossover film," says Patel. Does that mean no item numbers? We'll see.



RIGHT ON CUE

Most of the country would have been sleeping when Pankaj Advani won his first World Professional Billiards title at Leeds, but everyone's now woken up to his talent. From the start it looked like the 24-year-old Bangalore boy was on a mission to silence those who have doubted his ability to win a world championship. He maintained a clear lead and trounced nine-time world champion Mike Russell. With this, Advani has won all possible championships. Now what?

AP PHOTO



"I don't have any fears"

Karambir Singh Kang, GM of the Taj Mahal Hotel in Mumbai, has received the Hotelier of the Year Virtuoso Award. Even as the Taj was under attack on November 26, 2008, he stood tall, losing his wife and two sons. Kang now strives to make the hotel the finest in the world.

Q. What does winning the award mean to you?

A. It was a very emotional moment for me. Also, it feels good that the Taj is being recognised as a world class hotel.

Q. How does a hero deal with life and its challenges?

A. I don't consider myself a hero. I'm just an ordinary person. Anyone in my place would have reacted the same way.

Q. How did you ensure Taj's speedy recovery?

A. We have fantastic staff that put in their 100 per cent.



MIRACLE MAKER

Dr Suchitra N. Pandit might not be a name everyone recognises. But she's made one anxious couple very happy. Pandit, along with a 15-member team, helped a 24-year-old deliver India's first set of male quintuplets at Kokilaben Dhirubhai Ambani hospital. Yes, that's five babies. "We did four mock drills before D-day. The children were all delivered within three minutes," she says. High five.



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